LittleReads

Tobi's Amazing Robot

Science & Technology

Ages 6–8

by LittleReads Editorial Team

LittleReads

Tobi's Amazing Robot

by LittleReads Editorial Team

Ages 6–8 • Science & Technology

Published by LittleReads Publishing
www.littlereads.com

[illegible] He just [illegible] the way things fit together inside.

[illegible] Mama [illegible] would [illegible] bits of old radios, clocks, and toys scattered around his room. "Tobi!" she would call. "What happened to the kitchen timer?"

Chapter 1: The Science Fair

When Mrs. Adeyemi announced the school science fair, Tobi's eyes lit up.

"You can work in pairs or alone," she said. "Build something, grow something, or discover something. Use your imagination!"

Tobi knew exactly what he wanted to build. A robot.

But not just any robot. A robot from recycled materials. A robot that could wave, and blink, and maybe even dance.

"You are going to build a robot?" said his friend Nneka, wide-eyed. "That sounds really hard."

"It will be," said Tobi. "But I think I can do it."

Chapter 2: Failed Attempts

Tobi collected everything he could find: old cans, cardboard boxes, bottle caps, wires from a broken earphone, two old buttons, and a small motor from a toy car that no longer worked.

His first attempt was terrible. The body was too heavy and toppled over.

His second attempt fell apart when he tried to attach the arms.

His third attempt worked for about ten seconds before the head popped off and rolled across the floor.

Tobi sat in the middle of his mess and sighed. "Maybe Nneka was right. Maybe this is too hard."

He thought about throwing everything away. But then he remembered something his father always said: "Every expert was once a beginner who did not give up."

Chapter 3: A Better Design

The next day, Tobi did something different. Instead of building right away, he drew a plan.

He looked at pictures of real robots. He studied how joints work. He figured out that the body needed to be lighter, so he used a cardboard box instead of a tin can.

He used bottle caps as wheels, and the old earphone wires connected the buttons (eyes) to the small motor (for blinking).

His mother helped him cut some pieces safely. His father helped him tape the wires in place.

Step by step, piece by piece, the robot began to take shape.

Chapter 4: Sparks of Life

After three days of building, testing, fixing, and building again, Tobi pressed the battery into place.

For a moment, nothing happened.

Then the motor hummed. The button-eyes blinked. And the robot's cardboard arm slowly rose and fell, as if waving hello.

Tobi jumped up and down. "MAMA! MAMA! It works!"

His mother came running. When she saw the robot — lopsided, made of rubbish, but definitely waving — she clapped her hands and laughed.

"Tobi, that is the most beautiful robot I have ever seen."

Chapter 5: The Science Fair

On science fair day, Tobi carried his robot proudly to school. It was not as shiny as Nneka's volcano. It was not as big as Chidi's solar system. But when Tobi turned it on and it waved at the judges, everyone clapped.

Mrs. Adeyemi smiled. "And what is this made of?"

"Recycled materials," said Tobi. "Old cans, cardboard, bottle caps, and wires. Nothing was bought. Everything was reused."

The judges whispered to each other. Then they announced the winner.

Tobi won first place. Not just for the robot, but for the idea behind it — that amazing things can be made from things other people throw away.

Chapter 6: Keep Building

That night, Tobi put his first-place ribbon on the shelf next to his robot. He looked at it and smiled.

Then he pulled out more cardboard, more wires, and a new idea. He was already thinking about his next invention.

Because Tobi had learned something important: the best inventions do not come from perfect first attempts. They come from trying, failing, learning, and trying again.

And that is how every amazing thing begins.

What We Learned

- Tobi learned that failure is a step toward success, not the end.
- Drawing a plan before building is smart engineering.
- Recycling old materials is good for the environment.
- Perseverance and creativity go hand in hand.

Discussion Questions

1. Have you ever failed at something but kept trying?
2. What recycled materials could you use to make something new?
3. Why is making a plan before starting important?

LittleReads

Thank you for reading!

Big Adventures for Little Readers

www.littlereads.com